



Reading: Project Management Skills for Non-Project Managers

Estimated time: 3 minutes

Overview

Effective project management is no longer a skill limited to designated project managers. In today's fast-paced, cross-functional work environments, professionals across roles must understand how to manage time, resources, and teams to achieve organizational goals. This reading introduces learners to the PMI Talent Triangle, which highlights three essential categories of project management skills: Business Acumen, Ways of Working, and Power Skills. Each skill area contributes to holistic project management capability, enabling individuals to align actions with strategic objectives, adapt to evolving work methods, and foster effective collaboration.

The PMI Triangle

The PMI Talent Triangle organizes project management skills into three key categories—Ways of Working, Power Skills, and Business Acumen. It serves as a practical blueprint for anyone seeking to strengthen their PM capabilities and align with industry expectations.

Whether you're launching a product, improving a process, or managing a team, project management skills are the backbone of successful execution. The PMI Talent Triangle offers a clear path to build those skills—and stay competitive in a world where nearly every leadership role demands them.

Key categories of project management skills within the PMI Talent Triangle

The **PMI Talent Triangle** framework organizes project management capabilities into three main categories:

Skill category	Key skill

Category 1: Business Acumen Skills	Benefits management and realization
	Business models and structures
	Competitive analysis
	Customer relationships and satisfaction
	Industry domain knowledge
	Legal and regulatory compliance
	Market awareness
	Function-specific knowledge
	Strategic planning, analysis, alignment
Category 2: Ways of Working Skills	Agile and Hyper agile
	Hybrid
	Artificial Intelligence (AI)
	Design and systems thinking
	Transformation
	Data gathering and modeling

	Earned Value Management
	Governance
	Performance management
	Requirements management & traceability
	Risk management
	Schedule management
	Time, budget, and cost estimation
Category 3: Power Skills	Leadership
	Active listening
	Communications
	Adaptability
	Brainstorming
	Coaching and mentoring
	Conflict management
	Emotional Intelligence

	Influencing
	Interpersonal skills
	Negotiation
	Problem solving
	Teamwork

Each of these skill sets supports a different aspect of project execution:

- **Business Acumen** ensures alignment between project outcomes and business goals.
- **Ways of Working** focuses on the methods and tools used to deliver results efficiently.
- **Power Skills** emphasize interpersonal effectiveness and leadership capability.

Together, they enable professionals to manage complexity, drive innovation, and lead teams toward successful project delivery — even outside traditional project management roles.

Summary

In this reading you learned that the **PMI Talent Triangle** integrates *Business Acumen*, *Ways of Working*, and *Power Skills* for well-rounded project capability.

- **Business Acumen** links project decisions to organizational strategy and market needs.
- **Ways of Working** reflects adaptability and proficiency in diverse work methods (e.g., agile, hybrid).
- **Power Skills** strengthen collaboration, influence, and leadership effectiveness.
- Developing across all three areas enhances overall project success and career versatility.

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